

Verato — Design Partner Brief

The Problem

A Chief of Staff sits in 10–15 meetings a week. Every meeting produces commitments — "I'll get you the numbers by Thursday", "we'll have a proposal ready end of month", "John's team will send the draft by Friday." These promises are made verbally, captured nowhere, and followed up manually.

The result: the CoS spends hours every week chasing people by email and Slack, trying to remember what was promised, by whom, and when. Things slip. Deadlines pass. The CoS finds out too late to intervene. Relationships get strained by the chasing itself.

This is not a productivity problem. It is a structural gap in how leadership teams operate.

What Verato Does

Verato is a command centre for the Chief of Staff. It sits between your meetings and your team, doing three things automatically:

- 1. Captures every commitment from every meeting** Connect Google Calendar or Zoom once. When a meeting ends, Verato pulls the transcript, sends it to Gemini AI, and extracts every commitment — who promised what, to whom, by when — and surfaces them for review. No manual upload. No missed promises.
 - 2. Tracks and scores risk automatically** Every commitment gets an owner, a deadline, and a live risk score based on how close the deadline is, the owner's historical delivery rate, and how long since there was any update. The score is fully transparent — you can see exactly how much each factor contributes. The dashboard shows you what is on track, what is slipping, and what needs intervention — before it becomes a problem.
 - 3. Nudges owners and reads their replies** When a deadline approaches, Verato sends a Slack DM or email nudge to the action owner on a schedule you configure. When the owner replies — "done", "pushing to next week", "I'm blocked on X" — Verato reads the reply, updates the commitment status, and notifies the CoS. If the reply is ambiguous, the CoS sees the full text immediately and decides what to do. Nothing falls through the cracks.
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Who It Is For

Primary user: Chief of Staff, Executive Assistant, or Head of Operations — someone whose job is to make sure leadership commitments are kept across a complex organisation.

Organisation profile: 20–200 people. The leadership team meets regularly. Commitments are made across functions. There is no reliable system for tracking follow-through.

They feel this pain acutely. The CoS knows exactly which commitments are at risk. They just have no tool built for them — they are using spreadsheets, Notion databases, or nothing at all.

What Is Built Today

Verato is in private beta with a working product:

- **Guided onboarding** — new users are walked through connecting Slack and importing an existing commitment tracker before reaching the dashboard, so the product is useful from the first session
 - **Google Meet and Zoom auto-ingestion** — meetings processed automatically within 15 minutes of ending
 - **Tracker import** — upload a spreadsheet, CSV, or document of existing commitments at any time; Gemini extracts them just like a live transcript
 - **Gemini AI extraction** — commitments pulled from transcripts with owner, deadline, and confidence score
 - **Risk scoring with breakdown** — live score per commitment showing exactly how much deadline proximity, owner track record, and update recency each contribute
 - **Slack and Gmail nudges** — automatic DM and email nudges on a configurable schedule
 - **Reply parsing** — Gemini reads owner replies and updates status automatically; ambiguous replies surface the full text to the CoS for review
 - **Slack interactive buttons** — owners tap Done / Need More Time / Blocked directly in Slack
 - **Log Manual Update** — CoS can record verbal updates or out-of-band responses directly to the commitment history
 - **Strategic Initiatives** — tag-based grouping of commitments into named initiatives (Q3 Launch, Board Prep, etc.) with AI-generated health summaries and per-status counts
 - **Auto-tagging** — Gemini suggests tags for any commitment from your existing tag library in one click
 - **Delegation** — CoS can assign a colleague to manage meetings on their behalf
 - **In-app notifications** — personal feed for the CoS showing replies, updates, and meeting results
 - **Team management** — invite colleagues, manage access
 - **AI call transparency** — every Gemini call is logged with full input, output, duration, and linked context; all prompts are editable in the admin panel without a code deploy
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What We Are Looking For in a Design Partner

We are not looking for feedback on colours or fonts. We are looking for a design partner who works closely with a CoS or executive operations team and can help us answer:

- **Does the information hierarchy feel right?** The CoS needs to see what needs attention now — is the dashboard telling the right story at a glance?
- **Where does trust break down?** When does the CoS override Verato's interpretation and what does that tell us about the AI extraction quality?
- **Do Strategic Initiatives map to how you actually think?** We built a tag-based grouping system — does the concept of promoting a theme to an "initiative" match how a CoS organises their work?
- **What is missing from the commitment lifecycle?** Are there moments in how a CoS actually manages commitments that Verato does not yet support?
- **How does this fit into an existing workflow?** A CoS already has tools — email, Slack, a calendar, probably a Notion or spreadsheet. Where does Verato slot in and where does it create friction?

We will give you full access to the product, sit in on sessions where you use it with real meetings, and build what we learn into the product roadmap directly.

The Opportunity

The Chief of Staff market is underserved. The tools they use — project management software, spreadsheets, shared docs — were built for teams delivering work, not for the person orchestrating across functions. Verato is the first product built specifically for how a CoS operates.

If this resonates, we would love to show you the product and talk about what a design partnership could look like.

Verato — Private Beta Contact: kanags@gmail.com